Now to answer another question. There are I believe no nightingales at Tabreez, I never heard one north of Sultania. At Casveen, Tehran, and Ispahan during the rose season they make such a noise as to be almost unpleasant. After a day or two their constant singing is nearly annoying. I recollect one which appeared to sing four and twenty hours almost without stopping in a tree close to my window, most likely it was a succession of nightingales who kept up this singing, but the effect was as if one was constantly singing. The cats eat a great many of them. The Persians say the nightingales are in love with the roses, and that they sing to them until they lose their senses and being in a sort of singing rapture or stupor the cats catch them without much trouble. The love of the nightingale for the rose is the orthodox belief of the Persians, but I can bear witness to the fact, that their note is scarcely ever heard except in the rose season — let naturalists determine why.[81]

We have several sorts of roses here, some unknown in England until Sir Henry Willock took the plants there. Two or three sorts of double red roses the best is the "Gul i āteshi," the "fire rose" it is of a deep red colour without smell, another the same but smaller, called, "Gul i mishki," or "musk rose" with a fine perfume; this blooms for four months in the year. The "Gul Nestoran"[82] or "Nestorian rose" is single and grows in a bush sometimes twenty or thirty feet high the branches weeping like those of a willow and covered with white blossoms like garlands, this also blooms for four or five months, say from May to September, the perfume is so strong that four or five trees planted in a garden of fifty or sixty yards square, make the place smell as if the borders had been watered with rose water. We have also single yellow roses; a sort of sweet briar and others of a dark reddish coffee colour inside and pale yellow out, single with a disagreeable smell. This is the first rose in blossom and whilst in blossom makes a very fine show, the tree being covered with flowers, which however only last about ten days. Indeed none of the roses except those above mentioned last more than ten or fourteen days, (each flower may perhaps last two days) the sun has such power that they blossom and fade with great rapidity. —

Col Sheil until now Chargé d'affaires, has just been appointed Minister Pleni[y] — it is likely he will go home as he has bad health. The pay is six thousand a year, of which he will save nearly three if he remains in Persia, for he does not keep up a very splendid establishment. I think Mr Bonham has a good chance of this appointment some years hence. Dr Wolf has arrived at Tehran nearly driven mad they say by the hardships and anxiety he has endured. We expect him here in

[81] Nightingales are migratory and their prevalence in Persia is coincident with the rose season, cf. Robert B. M. Binning, *Journal of two years travel in Persia, etc.*, London, 1857, v. 2, p. 311.

[82] Similarly described by Binning, *l. c.*, as the *gul nasteran.*

Generated on 2020-09-16 00:01 GMT / https://hdl.handle.net/2027/mdp.39015035112393
Public Domain, Google-digitized / http://www.hathitrust.org/access_use#pd-google
Digitized by Google
Original from UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN